



Australian Government
Attorney-General's Department

MC23-026854

4 September 2023

Dr Rich Mclean
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Dear Dr Mclean

Thank you for your letter of 20 July 2023 to the Attorney-General, the Hon Mark Dreyfus KC MP, regarding public interest disclosures and a decision not to allocate a disclosure. The Attorney-General has requested that the Attorney-General's Department respond to you on his behalf. I apologise for the delay in response.

In your correspondence, you have stated that you have attempted to make a disclosure under the *Public Interest Disclosure Act 2013* (Cth) (PID Act).

The Attorney-General and the Attorney-General's Department are unable to provide legal advice to the public and have no power to intervene in matters relating to disclosures or decisions about allocation of disclosures under the PID Act. However, the following information may be of assistance to you.

The PID Act is an important element of the Commonwealth's integrity and transparency framework. The PID Act enables public officials to disclose suspected wrongdoing by another public official or by an Australian government agency, with the assurance of protections and immunities from liability.

If a public official is dissatisfied with how a PID has been handled or investigated, they may contact the Commonwealth Ombudsman to make a complaint. However, I note that it appears from your correspondence that you have already contacted the Office of the Commonwealth Ombudsman about an attempted disclosure and have been advised that further assistance is not available.

Finally, I want to acknowledge the difficulty you have described experiencing. I was sorry to hear this matter has been distressing for you. Should you wish to speak with someone about how you are feeling, I have listed below the details of counselling and support services which may be of assistance to you:

- Lifeline Crisis Support – Provides confidential support when you feel overwhelmed, when you have difficulty coping, or are having suicidal thoughts. Phone 13 11 14 or chat to a crisis supporter online at: www.lifeline.org.au.